

“We are entering into a more market driven era which is resulting in the creation of more and more free software, now mostly driven by large corporations”



Rushabh Mehta is a self-taught FOSS developer who moved on to become a contributor and maintainer of ERPNext, which is today one of the world's most popular ERP tools with a community of more than 10,000 members. Mehta shares his journey from learner to leader with **Longjam Dineshwori** of **EFY Networks**. He also sheds light on the current open source technology trends and the FOSS ecosystem in India.

my 2004 iBook with MacOS (which was based on Darwin UNIX). Later I discovered Python, which was a fantastic programming platform that had been introduced to the community. Unlike most people, I still use MacOS as my primary OS though most of the software we produce is FOSS.

The ERPNext story

I was always a hobbyist programmer. In an attempt to help my family's business, which was reeling from a bad ERP (enterprise resource planning) implementation, I started writing out my own ERP system in 2006. After a couple of years, the family business was sold but I decided to keep building the ERP system. In 2008, I started my own company, Frappe Technologies, to productionise the ERP that I was

As I see it, FOSS encompasses a wide range of free and/or open source software in various fields. More than the software, it is a growing movement involving people who want to share their creations with other people for the love of the craft. There are other angles to it, too, like whether having control over software is necessary (especially in the education

and public services domains) or how do you ensure sustainability and ongoing maintenance (commercialisation).

My first encounter with FOSS

I grew up in the early 90s, which was the Microsoft era with MS DOS dominating the space. It was a while before I discovered FOSS. Ironically, my first real open source tool was